

JOHN URSINO

Curriculum Vitae

Contact Information

Address: School of Criminology and Criminal Justice
University of Nebraska – Omaha
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Omaha, NE 68182

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Criminology and Criminal Justice <i>University of Nebraska – Omaha, Omaha, NE</i>	May 2026
Master of Arts, Criminal Justice <i>North Dakota State University, Fargo, ND</i>	May 2022
Bachelor of Arts, Criminal Justice <i>North Dakota State University, Fargo, ND — Minor in Political Science</i>	May 2021

HONORS AND AWARDS

Internal Honors

Order of Omega Honors Society <i>North Dakota State University</i>	2019–2021
Cum Laude <i>North Dakota State University</i>	2021
Summa Cum Laude <i>North Dakota State University</i>	2022

Awards

K. Clouston Family Political Science Endowment <i>North Dakota State University</i>	2021
Graduate Studies Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award <i>University of Nebraska – Omaha</i>	2023
Graduate Studies Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award <i>University of Nebraska – Omaha</i>	2024
Graduate Studies Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award <i>University of Nebraska – Omaha</i>	2025
ACJS Doctoral Summit Scholarship	2025

Helen Hansen Outstanding Graduate Student Award 2026
University of Nebraska – Omaha, Graduate Council Scholarship/Fellowship Committee

Council of Graduate Schools/ProQuest Distinguished Dissertation Award Nominee 2026
University of Nebraska – Omaha, College of Public Affairs and Community Service

Research Grants

Graduate Research and Creativity Activity Grant 2022–2023
University of Nebraska – Omaha

Graduate Research and Creativity Activity Grant 2024–2025
University of Nebraska – Omaha

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, & Kigerl, A. (2024). Advancing pretrial assessments: Development of the Personal Recognizance Interview & Needs Screen (PRINS). *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 92, 102183.

Hamilton, Z., Allen, B., **Ursino, J.**, Krushas, A., & Kigerl, A. (2024). Never Going to Let You Down: Preventing Predictive Shrinkage via the STRONG-R Assessment Method. *Justice Quarterly*, 42(7), 1279-1299.

Allen-Flores, B., Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, & Kigerl, A. (2024). Risk-Contamination and Dilution: Advancing the RNR Model in Prison Settings. *Crime and Delinquency*, 72(2), 391-415.

Ursino, J., Hayes, A., Allen-Flores, B., & Hamilton, Z. (2025). Short timers and idle populations in overcrowded prisons. *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 99, 102480.

Hamilton, Z., Mei, X., Tostlebe, J. J., Allen-Flores, B., **Ursino, J.**, & Kigerl, A. (2025). A methodological template for the next generation: Redesigning the STRONG-R needs assessment. *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 99, 102454.

Ursino, J., & Hamilton, Z. (2026). Unraveling Decarceration Policy and How It Affects Correctional Populations. *Justice Quarterly*, 1–31.

Hamilton, Z., Kigerl, A., Tostlebe, J., & **Ursino, J.** (forthcoming) Criminal History's Expiration Date: Universal Evidence of Decay. *Criminology*. 1-46

Ursino, J., & Hamilton, Z. (under review). Navigating Court Capacity and Constraints: Systems-Based Forecasting for Jail Populations.

Ursino, J. (under review). Correctional Population Dynamics: A Cointegration Analysis of Admissions, Releases, and System Equilibrium.

Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, Kim, Y., & Russel-Coprigh, N. (under review). Beyond Validation: Risk Assessment Versioning, Dynamic Risk Reductions, and the Minnesota Rehabilitation and Reinvestment Act.

Ursino, J. (in progress). Accuracy Without Alignment: Local Re-Calibration of Five Popular Risk Assessments.

TECHNICAL REPORTS

- Hamilton, Z., Allen, B., Kobie, B., **Ursino, J.**, Gildea, B., & Spohn, R. (2023). *Nebraska Department of Correctional Services Classification & Flow Project Technical Report: Phase II*. Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. Lincoln, NE.
- Hamilton, Z., Kigerl, A., & **Ursino, J.** (2023). *Personal Recognizance Interview & Needs Screen (PRINS) Evaluation and Revalidation*. Department of Adult and Juvenile Detention. King County, WA.
- Towne, K., Campbell, C., Miles-Steffens, M., Gildea, B., **Ursino, J.**, Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., Campagna, M., Kobie, A., Claxton, T., Dueland, L., & Grell, T. (2023). *Evidence-Based Inventory of Criminal Justice Programs in Nebraska*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research.
- Campagna, M., Towne, K., Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., Krushas, A., Gildea, B., **Ursino, J.**, Al Falatah, S., & Hayes, A. (2024). *Evaluation Report: Violence Reduction Program at the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.
- Campagna, M., Towne, K., Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., Krushas, A., Gildea, B., **Ursino, J.**, Al Falatah, S., & Hayes, A. (2024). *Process and Outcome Evaluation of the Anger Management High-Risk High-Need Program of Nebraska Department of Correctional Services*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.
- Campagna, M., Towne, K., Spohn, R., Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., Gildea, B., **Ursino, J.**, Al Falatah, S., & Hayes, A. (2024). *Process and Outcome Evaluation of the I-Help and O-Help Sex Offender Programs of Nebraska Department of Correctional Services*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.
- Hamilton, Z., Kigerl, A., Peterson, A., Dwue, G., & **Ursino, J.** (2024). *The Criminal Justice Base Rate Project: Final Report*. National Institute of Justice. Washington, D.C.
- Kearns, E., Hashimi, S., Hamilton, Z., Armstrong, G., Turner, N., Moelter, I., Vetter, S., Ursch, B., Jurkiewicz, A., **Ursino, J.**, Allen-Flores, B., & Hayes, A. (2024). *Managing the Exit of Incarcerated Violent Extremists in the Community: State of Practice Report*. National Counterterrorism Innovation, Technology, and Education (NCITE) Center. Omaha, NE.
- Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2025). *Whatcom County Public Safety Assessment Predictive Performance & Bias Evaluation*. Whatcom County, WA.
- Hamilton, Z., Foxall, M., & **Ursino, J.** (2025). *Lancaster County Criminal Justice System and Jail Assessment: Final Report*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.
- Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, & Kim, Y. (2025). *Validation of the LS/CMI for Minnesota Probation*. Nebraska Center for Justice Research, School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska Omaha.

RESEARCH BRIEFS

- Ursino, J.** (2023). Predictive Validity of the LSI-R on a Sample of Native American Females — Research Brief (Doc. #2023-003). *Nebraska Center for Justice Research*. Omaha, NE.
- Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, & Kigerl, A. (2023). Evaluation of King County's Pretrial Risk Assessment: The Personal Recognizance Interview & Needs Screen (PRINS) (Doc. #2023-002). *Nebraska Center for Justice Research*. Omaha, NE.

- Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, & Allen, B. (2023). Nebraska Department of Correctional Services Classification & Crowding Project — Research Brief (Doc. #2023-004). *Nebraska Center for Justice Research*. Omaha, NE.
- Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2024). Achieving Justice: Reducing Racial Bias in Criminal Justice Risk Assessments — Research Brief (Doc. #2024-005). *Nebraska Center for Justice Research*. Omaha, NE.
- Ursino, J.**, & Hamilton, Z. (2025). Decarceration and Public Safety in Washington State (Doc. #2025-001). *Nebraska Center for Justice Research*. Omaha, NE.
- Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2025) Evaluating the Whatcom County Public Safety Assessment - Research Brief (Doc. #2025-002). *Advancing Research in Corrections Lab*. Omaha, NE
- Ursino, J.**, Hamilton, Z., & Kim, Y. (2025). Validating the Minnesota Level of Service/Case Management Inventory (LS/CMI) — Research Brief (Doc. #2025-003). *Advancing Research in Corrections Lab*. Omaha, NE.
- Ursino, J.**, Hamilton, Z. (2026). Validating the South Dakota Violence Risk Appraisal Guide (VRAG) — Research Brief (Doc. #2026-001). *Advancing Research in Corrections Lab*. Omaha, NE.
- Ursino, J.**, Hamilton, Z. (2026). Validation of the Arizona Offender Screening Tool (OST) and Field Reassessment Offender Screening Tool (FROST) – Research Brief (Doc. #2026-002). *Advancing Research in Corrections Lab*. Omaha, NE.
- Ursino, J.**, Hamilton, Z. (2026). Validating the Alaska Level of Service Inventory-Revised (LSI-R) – Research Brief (Doc. #2026-003). *Advancing Research in Corrections Lab*. Omaha, NE.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Ursino, J.** (2022). *An Outcome Evaluation of CENTRE Incorporated's Responsive Risk Reduction for Women Program*. ProQuest (Master's Thesis; North Dakota State University).
- Ursino, J.**, Hamilton, Z., & Kigerl, A. (2024). *Improving Pre-Trial Risk Assessment*. American Jails Magazine.
- Ursino, J.** (2026). *Crowding, Capacity, and Reform: Exploring the Dynamics of Correctional Policy*. ProQuest (Doctoral Dissertation, University of Nebraska at Omaha).
- Ursino, J.** (under review). *Systems-Based Time Series Methods for Understanding Correctional Populations*. American Society of Criminology Division of Corrections and Sentencing Handbook on Corrections and Sentencing Methods.

FUNDED RESEARCH

- Co-Investigator. 2020–2021. BASE RATE PROJECT.** Developed criminal justice base rates for citizens across the majority of U.S. states to support actuarial research and risk assessment. Funded by the National Institute of Justice. \$133,250.
- Co-Investigator. 2020–2022. KING COUNTY PRINS REVALIDATION.** Revalidated the PRINS pretrial risk assessment for King County, Washington. Funded by King County. \$52,000.
- Co-Investigator. 2021–2022. NEBRASKA CLASSIFICATION PROCESS.** Examined the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services' classification, programming, and bed management practices

to identify operational barriers contributing to prison overcrowding. Funded by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. \$200,000.

Co-Investigator. 2020–2022. VOCATIONAL & LIFE SKILLS EVALUATION. Evaluated vocational and life skills programming delivered by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. Funded by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. \$329,571.

Principal Investigator. 2022–2023. WAONE REVALIDATION AND UPDATE. Validated the Washington Department of Corrections Offender Needs Evaluation (WAONE) and developed an updated version of the assessment. Funded by the Washington Department of Corrections. \$250,000.

Research Assistant. 2022–2023. VOCATIONAL & LIFE SKILLS EVALUATION. Contributed to the evaluation of vocational and life skills programming delivered by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. Funded by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. \$168,116.

Co-Investigator. 2022–2025. NDCS PROGRAM EVALUATION. Evaluated evidence-based violence reduction, anger management, sex offense treatment, and electronic monitoring programs implemented by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services to assess their impact on recidivism. Funded by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. \$852,475.

Research Assistant. 2023–2026. MANAGING THE EXIT OF INCARCERATED VIOLENT EXTREMISTS IN THE COMMUNITY HANDBOOK. Developed a practitioner handbook summarizing current and future needs of correctional agencies supporting the community reentry of incarcerated violent extremists. Funded by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security. \$1,622,181.

Co-Investigator. 2024–2026. LANCASTER COUNTY CRIMINAL JUSTICE SYSTEM AND JAIL ASSESSMENT. Examined factors contributing to jail population growth in Lancaster County and identified policy and operational strategies to address overcrowding. Funded by Lancaster County, Nebraska. \$125,000.

Co-Investigator. 2024–2025. VALIDATING THE MINNESOTA LS/CMI. Validated the predictive performance of the Minnesota Department of Corrections' Level of Service/Case Management Inventory (LS/CMI). Funded by the Minnesota Department of Corrections. \$147,424.

Co-Investigator. 2025–2026. WHATCOM COUNTY PUBLIC SAFETY ASSESSMENT EVALUATION. Evaluated the predictive validity, calibration, and fairness of the Public Safety Assessment (PSA) and provided recommendations to support evidence-based pretrial decision-making in Whatcom County, Washington. Funded by Whatcom County. \$30,000.

Co-Investigator. 2024–Present. ADULT TREATMENT COURT TRAINING INITIATIVE AND VETERAN TREATMENT COURT TRAINING AND TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE. Developed risk and needs assessment instruments for adult and veteran treatment courts to improve participant assessment and guide individualized supervision and treatment planning. Funded by the National Drug Court Institute. \$300,000.

Co-Investigator. 2025–Present. NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF CORRECTIONAL SERVICES REENTRY ASSESSMENT. Evaluating NDCS's current risk and needs assessment used for parole decision-making and modifying to the tool to improve performance. Funded by the Nebraska Department of Correctional Services. \$35,000,

Co-Investigator. 2026–Present. THE IOWA RISK & NEEDS ASSESSMENT EVALUATION AND DEVELOPMENT. Developing a risk and needs assessment for the Iowa Board of Parole to improve parole decision-making and support prison population reduction. Funded by the Laura and John Arnold Foundation (Causal Research on Community Safety and Criminal Justice). \$889,482.

PROFESSIONAL AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Held Positions

Research Specialist – Advancing Research in Corrections (ARC) Lab

Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Omaha

May 2026 – Present
Omaha, NE

- Conduct applied correctional research specializing in risk assessment, program evaluation and evidence-based policy for criminal justice agencies.

Research Assistant – Nebraska Center for Justice Research (NCJR)

Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Omaha

Aug 2023 – May 2026
Omaha, NE

- Supported correctional program evaluations through literature reviews, quantitative and qualitative data analysis, site visits, stakeholder interviews, and technical report development.

Graduate Research Assistant – University of Nebraska – Omaha

Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Omaha

Aug 2022 – May 2026
Omaha, NE

- Contributed to research projects by conducting literature reviews, collecting and analyzing data and assisting in the development of research reports.

Academic Advisor / Graduate Assistant

Athletic Academic Department, North Dakota State University

Aug 2020 – May 2022
Fargo, ND

- Met weekly with student-athletes to ensure academic plans met university and NCAA requirements, including assisting students acquire academic resources and completing progress reports for coaching and university staff.

Learning Assistant

English Department, North Dakota State University

Aug 2020 – May 2021
Fargo, ND

- Monitored the learning environment and provided technical assistance for distance learning, along with writing assistance to students.

Teaching — Instructor of Record

Introduction to Criminal Justice (undergraduate)

School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Lincoln

January Term 2025

Survey of Correctional Systems in Criminal Justice (undergraduate)

School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Lincoln

Summer Term 2025

Introduction to Criminological Theory (undergraduate)

School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Omaha

Summer Term 2026

Teaching Workshops, Courses, and Course Development

- Teaching Criminal Justice at the University Level (Spring 2024)
- Foundations of Online Teaching (Spring 2024)
- Creating an Engaging, Equitable, and Inclusive Online Class (Fall 2024)
- The AI Advantage: Transforming Teaching and Preparing Students to Thrive (Fall 2024)
- Continuing the Momentum: Foundations of Online Teaching (Fall 2024)
- Improving Course Accessibility: Advancing Excellence in Teaching (Spring 2025)

- Aided in development of a doctoral-level statistics course, University of Nebraska – Omaha (Fall 2025)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND INVOLVEMENT

Reviewer for:

Journal of Research in Crime and Delinquency Feb. 2026

Victim & Offenders Apr. 2025

Memberships

Crime and Justice Public Opinion Lab Aug. 2022 – May 2025
Member University of Nebraska – Omaha

American Society of Criminology Sept 2022 – Present
Member

Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences Oct 2022 – Present
Member

Graduate Students Organization Jan 2023 – Aug 2024
Treasurer, Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice

The Association of Blacks and Browns in Criminal Justice Sept 2023 – May 2025
Member University of Nebraska – Omaha

Workshops

Statistical Horizons Course on Treatment Effect Analysis November 2022
Participant

Statistical Horizons Course on Time Series Analysis November 2023
Participant

Statistical Horizons Course on Longitudinal Data Analysis April 2024
Participant

Clear Writing for Crime Researchers Interactive Workshop November 2024
Participant American Society of Criminology 2024 Annual Meeting

Statistical Horizons Course on Causal Inference and Outcome-Wide Studies February 2025
Participant

Statistical Horizons Course on Causal Inference in Econometrics March – April 2025
Participant

Statistical Horizons Course on Causal Inference for Multilevel Data May 2025
Participant

INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND LECTURES

Invited Presentations

Hamilton, Z., Kigerl, A., & **Ursino, J.** (2023). "Personal Recognizance Interview & Needs Screen (PRINS)." King County, WA. December 15, 2023.

Ursino, J., & Hamilton, Z. (2024). "Lancaster County Criminal Justice System and Jail Assessment." Omaha, NE. September 19, 2024.

Hamilton, Z., **Ursino, J.**, Bostwick, D., & Monteiro, A. (2025). "Lancaster County Criminal Justice System and Jail Assessment — Presentation to Lancaster County Board of Commissioners." Lincoln, NE. August 18, 2025.

Ursino, J., & Hamilton, Z. (2025). "County Jail Population Trends and System Forecasting." American Jail Association — Jail Executive Speaker Series. December 11, 2025.

Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2026). "Identifying and Forecasting Sources of Jail Overcrowding — Presentation to League of Women Voters of Lincoln-Lancaster." Omaha, NE. February 15, 2026.

Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2026). "Whatcom County, Washington PSA Evaluation." Omaha, NE. February 16, 2026.

Ursino, J., & Hamilton, Z. (2026). "Creating the Nebraska Department of Corrections Reentry Assessment." Omaha, NE. February 19, 2026.

Invited Lectures

Ursino, J. "Contemporary Challenges in Correctional Case Management." School of Criminology and Criminal Justice, University of Nebraska – Omaha, Omaha, NE.

Ursino, J. "Education, Treatment, and Rehabilitation in Correctional Institutions." Department of Criminal Justice, Wayne State College, Wayne, NE.

Ursino, J. "The Correctional Client." Department of Criminal Justice, Wayne State College, Wayne, NE. [Invited Lecture].

Ursino, J. "Causal Analysis for Program and Policy Evaluation." College of Public Affairs and Community Service, University of Nebraska – Omaha, Omaha, NE.

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATIONS

Ursino, J., Hamilton, Z., Allen-Flores, B., & Kigerl, A. (2023). "The Impact of Short-Timers on Prison Crowding." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 17, 2023.

Allen-Flores, B., Hamilton, Z., Kobie, A., & **Ursino, J.** (2023). "Nebraska Classification Matching." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 17, 2023.

Allen-Flores, B., **Ursino, J.**, & Hamilton, Z. (2023). "The Impacts of Decarceration on Individuals Who Remain Incarcerated." Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences Annual Conference. March 19, 2023.

Ursino, J. (2023). "Unraveling Decarceration Policy and How It Affects Correctional Populations." Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences Annual Conference. March 23, 2023.

Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., **Ursino, J.**, Allen, B., & Kigerl, A. (2024). "Measuring Desistance via Decay: Making Criminal History Dynamic." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. Salt Lake City, UT.

Allen-Flores, B., Hamilton, Z., & **Ursino, J.** (2024). "What About Those We Left Behind? The Unintended Consequences of Decarceration for Those Still Incarcerated." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 13, 2024.

- Ursino, J.**, & Hamilton, Z. (2024). "Exploring a Generation's Bias: A Multi-State Evaluation of the LSI-R." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 15, 2024.
- Campagna, M., **Ursino, J.**, Al Falatah, S., & Gildea, B. (2024). "Evaluating Violence Programming in Prison: Comparing Cognitive-Behavioral and Psycho-Educational Approaches." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 15, 2024.
- Spohn, R., Al Falatah, S., Tostlebe, J., & **Ursino, J.** (2024). "Sex Offender Treatment: An Evaluation of the Effectiveness of Prison- and Community-Based Programming." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 15, 2024.
- Ursino, J.** (2025). "Quantifying Miscalibration: Estimating the Impact of Demographic Differences on the LSI-R." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 13, 2025.
- Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., & **Ursino, J.** (2025). "Recidivism and Redemption: Developing Risk Assessment Using Dynamic Criminal History." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 13, 2025.
- Hamilton, Z., Tostlebe, J., **Ursino, J.**, Allen, B., & Kigerl, A. "Measuring desistance via decay: Making criminal history dynamic." American Society of Criminology Annual Conference. November 13, 2025.